Paragraph Pitfalls

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Functional English (SS1012)

Infinity Paragraph (Too Long)

- Feels endless; readers lose track of ideas.
- Lacks **internal coherence** (poor transitions within) and **external coherence** (weak link to other paragraphs).

Fix: Break it into 2–3 shorter, well-connected paragraphs using clear transitions.



Hiccup Paragraph (Too Short)

- Begins and ends abruptly; ideas feel undeveloped.
- A few short paragraphs may emphasize a point, but too many show weak development.

Fix: Combine short paragraphs and explain relationships between ideas to build depth.



Blindfold Paragraph (Unclear Topic Sentence)

- Starts too broadly; reader doesn't know what the paragraph is really about until later.
- Threatens unity because readers may assume the wrong topic.

Fix: Delete vague opening sentences and bring the main idea to the start (clear topic sentence).



Maze Paragraph (Confusing Middle)

- Has a clear start and end, but ideas in the middle are disorganized.
- Reader gets lost among unrelated or poorly linked details.

Fix: Check logical order and relevance of ideas; use transitions (however, similarly, in contrast, etc.).



Cliff-Hanger Paragraph (No Conclusion)

- Ends suddenly without summarizing or connecting to the next idea.
- Often ends with a quotation instead of a concluding thought.

Fix: Add a clear **concluding sentence** that summarizes the point or leads to the next paragraph.

